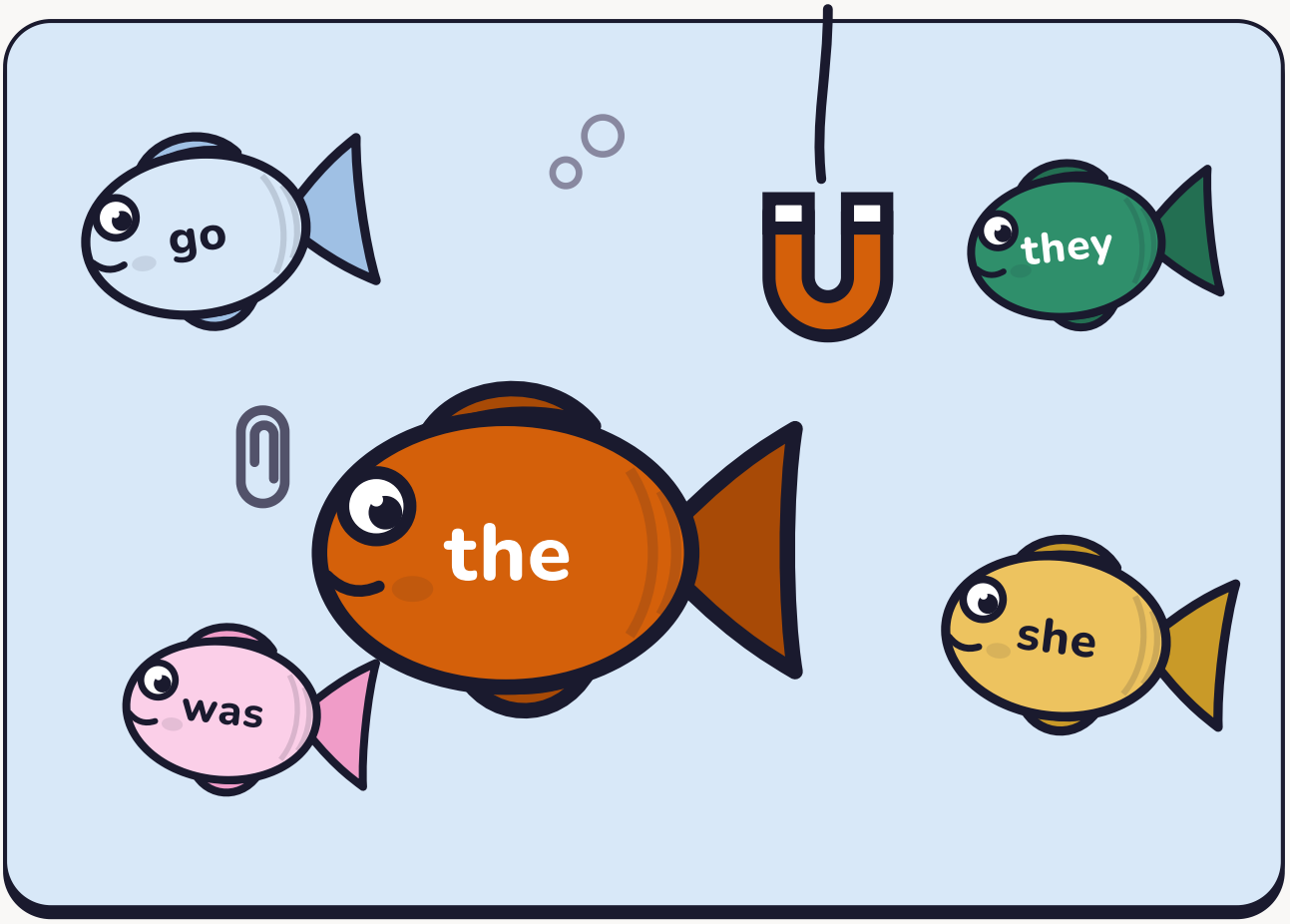
Word Fishing

Print it. Build it. Fish for words.



The 10 minute build | **Ages 4 to 7** | **Phase 2 and Phase 3 tricky words**

A paperclip on every fish, a magnet on a string, and suddenly reading practice is the best game in the house.

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guidedchildhood.com/free/word-fishing

BUILD ONCE · PLAY FOR YEARS

The 10 minute build

Prep 10 minutes

Mess level low

Grown up on scissors

Everything here is already in your kitchen drawer. No glue, no paint, no trip to the shops.

You will need	How many	Nice to have
A4 paper or thin card	**6 sheets**	Laminating pouches, so the fish survive years of little hands
Scissors	**1 pair**	Kid safe scissors, so your child can cut the straight bits
Paperclips	**1 per fish, about 60**	Coloured clips that flash like scales in the pond
A magnet	**1, fridge magnet strength**	A magnetic letter borrowed from the fridge works a treat
String or wool	**About 50 cm**	A second string, so two children can fish at once
A wooden spoon or a stick	**1**	A stick from the garden makes it feel like real fishing
Something blue for the pond	**1 towel, scarf or tray**	A big blue scarf makes a properly splashy pond

STEP 1



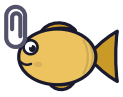
Print.
Pages 4 to 9 on paper or thin card.

STEP 2



Cut.
Cut round each dashed card. Grown up on scissor duty.

STEP 3



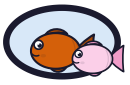
Clip.
Laminate if you can, then slide a paperclip on every fish nose.

STEP 4



Rig the rod.
Tie string to the spoon, tie the magnet to the string.

STEP 5



Fill the pond.
Scatter the fish on the blue fabric, clips up. Go fish!

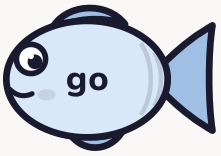
The laminate tip. Laminated fish shrug off juice, bath water and garden ponds, and a dry wipe pen turns the blank fish on page 9 into an endless spelling list. One print, years of fishing.

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THREE GAMES · ONE POND

How to play



Start with game one. When the catching gets confident, move up. Five minutes a day beats an hour on Sunday.

1

Catch and say

Dangle the magnet, catch a fish, read the word out loud. Read it right and the fish goes in your bucket. Stuck on one? Say the word together, throw the fish back, and it will swim round again. Most fish when the pond is empty wins.

2

Word match

The grown up calls a word: catch me the word **was**. The child fishes until they land it, checking each catch against the call. This is reading with a mission, and it is sneakily the hardest workout on the page.

3

Beat the clock

Set a timer for 2 minutes. How many fish can you catch and read before it beeps? Write the score somewhere proud and try to beat it tomorrow. Children race their own best, never each other.

KEEP IT PLAYFUL

This is a game, never a test. If a word is tricky today, say it cheerfully, let them repeat it, and move on. The magic of Word Fishing is that your child asks to play again, so the practice happens on its own. End every game while it is still fun.

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